The leanquote package

Quote Lean declarations in LaTeX by name

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https://github.com/slef/leanquote

Abstract

leanquote typesets declarations of a Lean 4 file in a LaTeX document by name: `\leanfile{Abstract.lean}` followed by `\leanquote{main_theorem}` prints the declaration `main_theorem` exactly as it appears in the Lean source, read at compile time. The prose stays in LaTeX, and the code is never retyped or pasted. A misspelled name is an error, and the package warns when the Lean file has changed since Lean last compiled it. It needs nothing on the Lean side beyond the usual `lake build`; an optional exporter lets Lean itself report the exact extent of each declaration. It works with pdfLaTeX, LuaLaTeX, and XeLaTeX.

1 Why

Papers that use a formalization often reproduce its definitions and main theorem statements, so that a reader can check that the formal statements say what the paper claims. Pasting code by hand invites the copy in the paper to drift from the code that Lean checked. With leanquote the paper names the declarations it wants, and LaTeX copies them from the Lean file each time the paper is compiled. The package was written for papers that present a short, human-readable `Abstract.lean`, containing the definitions and main statements of a formalization and proved through a bridge to the full development, but it works with any Lean 4 file.

2 Usage

```
\usepackage{leanquote}
\leanquotesetup{project=../lean/}            % root of the Lake project (optional)

\leanfile{TranslationTiling/Abstract.lean}  % current file
A prototile is a finite list of points of $\mathbb{Z}^3$:
\leanquote{Point, Prototile}
```

produces (with the file shipped in the package's `example` directory):

A prototile is a finite list of points of $\mathbb{Z}^3$:

```
abbrev Point := Fin 3 → ℤ
```

```
abbrev Prototile := List Point
```

\leanfile[⟨*options*⟩]{⟨*file*⟩} sets the current file for the following **\leanquote** commands. Options given here apply to all of them. The path is relative to **project**, if set.

\leanquote[⟨*options*⟩]{⟨*names*⟩} typesets the comma-separated declarations ⟨*names*⟩ of the current file, together, in one listing.

\leanfilequote[⟨*options*⟩]{⟨*file*⟩}{⟨*names*⟩} does the same for an explicitly given file.

\leanquotesetup{⟨*options*⟩} sets options for the rest of the document (or the current group).

Names may be short (**Tiles**) or qualified (**TranslationTiling.Abstract.Tiles**). A qualified name matches a declaration inside the corresponding **namespace**: either name may be a dotted suffix of the other. An unknown name is an error; an ambiguous one is a warning, and the first match is used.

With the **doc** option, the doc comment is included:

```
\leanquote[doc]{Tiles}
```

```
/-- `P` tiles `ℤ³`: for some set `T` of translations, every point `x` lies in
      exactly
one translate `t + P` with `t ∈ T`, i.e., for exactly one `t ∈ T` we have `x - t ∈
      P`. -/
def Tiles (P : Prototile) : Prop :=
  ∃ T : Set Point, ∀ x : Point, ∃! t : Point, t ∈ T ∧ x - t ∈ P
```

3 Options

Option	Default	Meaning
doc	false	also show each declaration's doc comment
box	true	put the listing in a light frame (**leanquotebox**)
logo=⟨*file*⟩	none	image in the frame's top-right corner
style=⟨*name*⟩	**leanquote**	listings style used for the code
project=⟨*dir*⟩**/**	empty	root of the Lake project
olean=⟨*file*⟩		compiled file to compare with, if not at the standard place
check	true	warn if the code may not be what Lean compiled
root=, **source=**		for explicit exports: where the recorded source is
any other key		passed to **\lstinputlisting**

4 How declarations are found

The package reads the Lean file with LaTeX's own file input and uses the standard layout of Lean code. A declaration starts at a line in column 0 of the form

`[@[`⟨*attributes*⟩`]] [`⟨*modifiers*⟩`]` ⟨*keyword*⟩ ⟨*name*⟩ `...`

where ⟨*keyword*⟩ is one of `def`, `theorem`, `lemma`, `abbrev`, `structure`, `inductive`, `instance`, `class`, `axiom`, `opaque`, and the modifiers are `private`, `protected`, `noncomputable`, `partial`, `unsafe`, `nonrec`. Attribute lines just above it are included, and so is the doc comment if `doc` is set. The declaration continues while lines are blank, indented, or start with `|`, `termination_by`, `decreasing_by` or `deriving`; trailing blank lines are dropped. This matches the layout used by Mathlib and by most Lean code, including `match` alternatives and `inductive` constructors.

5 Was the code compiled?

LaTeX does not run Lean. But Lake writes a module's compiled file (`.lake/build/lib/lean/.../File.olean`) only when it builds successfully, so after a successful `lake build` the `.olean` is newer than its `.lean` source. With `project` set to the root of the Lake project, leanquote compares the two modification dates and warns if the source is newer:

```
Package leanquote Warning: ../lean/TranslationTiling/Abstract.lean is newer
(leanquote)  than its compiled file ... The code shown may not be what Lean
(leanquote)  checked: run lake build.
```

If no `.olean` is found (for instance, for a copy of the file outside its project), the package only notes in the log that it cannot check.

6 Optional: exact boundaries from Lean

For files laid out unusually, Lean itself can report where each declaration starts and ends. From the root of the Lake project, run the exporter shipped with the package:

```
path/to/leanquote/leanquote-export TranslationTiling.Abstract [More.Modules ...]
```

It builds each module and writes `.lake/build/leanquote/TranslationTiling/Abstract.leanquote`, inside the build directory. From then on, `\leanquote` finds this export automatically and uses Lean's declaration ranges; nothing changes in the document. The export also records the source as compiled. If the `.lean` file is edited afterwards, the package warns and falls back to reading the `.lean` file directly, so the document always shows the current code. The exporter is a single Lean file (`lean/LeanQuoteExport.lean`) run with `lake env lean -run`; nothing is added to the Lean project. An export placed next to the `.lean` file is also found, and an export can be quoted explicitly with `\leanfilequote{Abstract.leanquote}{...}`.

7 Engines and symbols

The `leanquote` listings style typesets about a hundred of Lean's Unicode symbols ($\mathbb{N}\ \mathbb{Z}\ \mathbb{R}\ \to\ \forall\ \exists\ \sum\ \bigcup\ \leq \ldots$, Greek letters, sub- and superscripts) as math, under pdfLaTeX through listings' `literate` mechanism, and under LuaLaTeX and XeLaTeX by making these characters active inside listings. Other symbols can be added with `literate` in a style of your own (pdfLaTeX), or by choosing a monospace font that contains them (LuaLaTeX, XeLaTeX). The package loads listings, xcolor, graphicx, amssymb, and tcolorbox with its `skins` and `breakable` libraries. It writes one temporary file ⟨*jobname*⟩`-leanquote-`⟨*n*⟩`.lean` per listing.

8 Texlish

Texlish passes LaTeX commands through, and its one-argument syntax reads naturally:

```
::use leanquote
\leanfile: Abstract.lean
\leanquote: main_theorem
```

With an optional argument, use braces: `\leanquote[doc]{main_theorem}`.

9 Limitations

- Without an export, declaration boundaries follow the layout rules above; code that puts continuation lines in column 0 (other than the listed keywords) is cut short.
- Namespaces are not tracked: two declarations with the same short name in different namespaces give an ambiguity warning; quote them with a name that distinguishes them.
- The compiled check relies on file modification dates; copying a project without preserving them can cause false warnings or hide stale code.

10 Related tools

Several tools include code from source files in documents; as far as we know, none quotes Lean declarations by name in an ordinary LaTeX document or checks the quoted code against the compiled module.

- **Marker-based inclusion in LaTeX.** catchfilebetweentags (`\ExecuteMetaData`), listings line ranges with marker comments, piton ranges, and tagsnip include the code between markers that the author adds to the source; minted's `rangeregex` selects code by a regular expression, and Pygments has a Lean 4 lexer. These work for any language but need markers or patterns, and do not know Lean's declarations.
- **Lean-native documents.** Verso and SubVerso, by the Lean FRO, include anchored regions of Lean modules in documents written in Verso, with Lean's own highlighting, and fail when a code block no longer matches its module; Verso's manual genre also produces TeX. They are the natural choice for documents written in Lean; leanquote is for papers written in LaTeX.
- **Blueprints.** leanblueprint's `\lean{...}` links informal statements to Lean declarations by name, and `checkdecls` checks that the names exist; LeanArchitect generates blueprint text from annotated Lean declarations (`\inputleannode{...}`). Both connect LaTeX and Lean by name, without quoting code, and can be used together with leanquote.
- **Other proof assistants.** Isabelle's document preparation and the cartouches tool (formerly isasnips), which names snippets after declarations; Agda's LaTeX backend combined with catchfilebetweentags; and Alectryon for Rocq. There the checker itself generates the document, which keeps code and proofs in sync.

- **Lean listings style.** Lean's documentation provides `lstlean.tex`, a listings definition of Lean with a Unicode table, which inspired ours.

The idea of including Lean snippets in papers to keep them in sync with the code was raised on the Lean Zulip by Eric Wieser in 2022 (thread "MathemaTeX").

11 License and history

leanquote is released under the MIT License. It grew out of a position paper by the authors on presenting the formal statements of machine-checked results to human readers.

0.6 (2026-10-25) Timestamps compared with LaTeX3's `\file_compare_timestamp`; related tools.

0.5 LuaLaTeX and XeLaTeX support; documentation.

0.4 Renamed from leandecl; `\leanfile` and `\leanquote`.

0.3 Optional exports used automatically when up to date.

0.2 Direct reading of `.lean` files; compiled check.

0.1 First version, based on exports.